NHMEC

Community Herbalist Diploma

Level II – Applied Studies

MODULE 7

Community Outreach, Herbal Events & Wellness Leadership

Module Overview

Community herbalism reaches beyond the classroom.

A Community Herbalist serves by building relationships, encouraging healthy lifestyles, preserving traditional plant knowledge, and creating opportunities for people to learn together.

Many people first discover herbalism through a community event—a farmers market demonstration, herb walk, wellness fair, church class, community garden, or educational workshop. These events introduce people to herbs in a welcoming, practical, and ethical way.

This module prepares you to organize and lead educational outreach activities that strengthen your community while remaining within an educational scope of practice.

Module Objectives

Upon successful completion of this module, students will be able to:

• Plan a community herbal outreach event.

• Organize educational herb walks.

• Develop church and community wellness programs.

• Recruit and coordinate volunteers.

• Build partnerships with community organizations.

• Promote herbal education ethically.

• Evaluate the success of community programs.

Required Reading

Read the sections of the **Community Herbalist eGuide** related to:

• Community Outreach

• Herbal Leadership

• Community Events

• Public Education

• Community Partnerships

• Volunteer Service

While reading, make notes regarding:

• Ways to serve your community.

• Examples of outreach.

• Educational opportunities.

• Leadership qualities.

Learning Outcomes

By the end of this module, students will understand how thoughtful outreach can strengthen families, preserve herbal traditions, and encourage lifelong learning within their communities.

Instructor Lecture

Community Herbalism Is About People

Although herbs are central to community herbalism, people are always the focus.

Every outreach activity should answer one question:

"How can this event educate and serve the community?"

Successful outreach creates welcoming environments where people feel encouraged to learn, ask questions, and develop confidence.

Community events should never be about selling products or promoting yourself. Instead, they should inspire curiosity, stewardship, and responsible herbal education.

Building Community Relationships

Strong partnerships create stronger communities.

Potential partners include:

Churches

Libraries

Schools

Extension offices

Community gardens

Farmers markets

Nature centers

Senior centers

Homeschool groups

Health ministries

Local nonprofits

Working together allows educational programs to reach more people.

Planning a Community Event

Every successful event begins with careful planning.

Ask yourself:

Who is the audience?

What is the educational goal?

Where will the event be held?

What supplies are needed?

Who will help?

How will participants register?

How will success be measured?

Planning reduces stress and creates a positive experience for everyone involved.

Types of Community Herbal Events

Community Herbalists may organize:

Herb walks

Medicinal plant identification classes

Garden tours

Tea tastings

Herbal preparation demonstrations

Children's nature programs

Church wellness ministries

Seed exchanges

Garden workdays

Farm stand education days

Community wellness fairs

Seasonal herbal workshops

Each event should have a clear educational purpose.

Leading an Herb Walk

Herb walks are one of the most effective ways to teach plant identification.

A successful herb walk includes:

Welcome and introductions

Safety briefing

Respect for nature

Plant identification

Traditional uses

Habitat observations

Questions and discussion

Closing review

Always remind participants not to consume wild plants unless they have been positively identified and are known to be safe.

Volunteer Leadership

Most successful community programs depend on volunteers.

Good volunteer leaders:

Communicate clearly.

Assign responsibilities.

Show appreciation.

Provide training.

Encourage teamwork.

Lead by example.

Volunteers who feel valued are more likely to remain involved.

Promoting Community Events

Educational events can be promoted through:

Community bulletin boards

Church newsletters

Social media

Libraries

Garden clubs

Local newspapers

Farmers markets

Word of mouth

Promotional materials should focus on education rather than making health claims.

Evaluating Success

After every event ask:

What went well?

What could improve?

How many people attended?

What questions were asked?

What topics generated the most interest?

Would participants attend another event?

Evaluation helps improve future programs.

Biblical Reflection

Galatians 6:10 (KJV)

"As we have therefore opportunity, let us do good unto all men, especially unto them who are of the household of faith."

Community herbalism is an opportunity to serve others through kindness, education, stewardship, and generosity. Every class taught and every seed planted can become an act of service that benefits both present and future generations.

Vocabulary

Define the following:

Community Outreach

Volunteer

Partnership

Networking

Herb Walk

Public Education

Community Wellness

Leadership

Event Planning

Evaluation

Reflection Questions

1. What outreach opportunities exist within your community?
2. Which type of community event would you most enjoy organizing?
3. Why are partnerships important?
4. How can herbal education strengthen local communities?
5. What leadership qualities would help you organize successful events?
6. How can volunteers improve community outreach?
7. What outreach project would you like to develop after graduation?

Practical Activity

Attend a Community Event

Visit one community event such as:

Farmers market

Garden tour

Nature walk

Health fair

Church outreach

Extension workshop

Community festival

Observe:

Organization

Educational value

Volunteer involvement

Public participation

Safety

Ways herbal education could be incorporated

Write a two-page evaluation.

Community Mapping Exercise

Create a map of your local community.

Identify at least ten locations where herbal education could be offered.

Examples:

Churches

Schools

Libraries

Community centers

Parks

Nature preserves

Farmers markets

Senior centers

Homeschool co-ops

Extension offices

For each location describe one possible educational activity.

Assignment

Design a Community Herbal Outreach Event

Create a complete event proposal.

Include:

Event title

Purpose

Target audience

Learning objectives

Location

Schedule

Supply list

Volunteer assignments

Budget

Marketing plan

Safety considerations

Evaluation form

Follow-up plan

Minimum length:

8–10 pages.

Mini Quiz

1. The primary goal of community outreach is to:

A. Sell herbal products

B. Educate and serve the community

C. Replace medical care

D. Promote personal recognition

1. An herb walk should always include:

A. Encouraging participants to eat unknown plants

B. Plant identification and safety education

C. Selling herbs

D. Medical diagnosis

1. Successful community events depend upon:

A. Expensive equipment only

B. Careful planning and organization

C. Large advertising budgets

D. Memorization

1. Volunteers should be:

A. Ignored after the event

B. Appreciated and supported

C. Assigned without instruction

D. Discouraged from participating

1. Community partnerships help:

A. Expand educational opportunities

B. Reduce community involvement

C. Eliminate volunteers

D. Replace education

Answer Key

1. B
2. B
3. B
4. B
5. A

Module Project

Develop a One-Year Community Herbal Outreach Plan

Design a twelve-month outreach calendar.

Include one educational event for each month.

Examples:

Winter Tea Workshop

Spring Herb Walk

Medicinal Garden Planting Day

Summer Wellness Fair

Children's Nature Camp

Farmers Market Demonstration

Seed Saving Workshop

Harvest Celebration

Autumn Herbal Preparation Class

Holiday Herbal Gifts Workshop

For each event include:

Objectives

Audience

Location

Volunteers

Materials

Estimated budget

Marketing ideas

Evaluation methods

Community Herbal Journal

Record:

Five outreach ideas for your community.

Three organizations you would like to partner with.

Two leadership skills you would like to strengthen.

One outreach event you plan to organize within the next year.

Module Completion Checklist

☐ Required reading completed

☐ Vocabulary completed

☐ Reflection questions answered

☐ Community event attended

☐ Community map completed

☐ Outreach proposal submitted

☐ Annual outreach calendar completed

☐ Quiz passed (80% or higher)

☐ Herbal Journal updated

Service Learning Project (Required)

Complete **five hours of community service** related to herbal education or environmental stewardship.

Examples include:

• Assisting in a community garden

• Volunteering at a church wellness event

• Leading a short herb walk

• Helping with a seed exchange

• Teaching a beginner herbal class

• Supporting a local farmers market educational booth

Write a two-page reflection describing:

• What you learned

• Challenges encountered

• Community impact

• How the experience strengthened your understanding of community herbalism

Looking Ahead

In **Module 8**, you will bring together everything you have learned by studying **leadership, ethics, professionalism, and long-term planning for the Community Herbalist**. You will develop a personal mission statement, establish professional standards, build a lifelong learning plan, and begin preparing your final Community Herbalist Capstone Portfolio and Diploma Project.